ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 20 × 1 = 20

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** dramatic irony	A wish granted in a harmful way.
2	**(b)** a symbol of acceptance of democracy by former opponents	Symbolic reading.
3	**(b)** internal conflict	The fight is within his mind.
4	**(d)** shows a girl growing in self-awareness	She reflects on herself.
5	**(b)** sensory and nostalgic detail	Memory images.
6	**(b)** a source of comic understatement and character revelation	It shows character and fuels humour.
7	**(c)** turning point	The cow incident changes the mood.
8	**(c)** therapeutic	It heals through insight.
9	**(c)** formal purpose and petty behaviour	Dignity versus pettiness.
10	**(a)** the 'surgery' that triumphs is merely the clinic's plain care	Irony.
11	**(c)** a thief is reformed by the trust of the man he planned to rob	Intended victim becomes saviour.
12	**(d)** falls while trying to use an escape route that does not exist	A trickster is tricked.
13	**(a)** a professional thief is fooled by a cleverer impostor	Situational irony.
14	**(a)** his greatest triumph becomes his greatest burden	Triumph brings isolation.
15	**(d)** grows through curiosity, support and effort	Making, not birth.
16	**(c)** the characters suffer ten years for a worthless object	Irony of fate.
17	**(b)** a girl called simple proves wise and brave	Label versus reality.
18	**(c)** a harmless children's book prevents a planned invasion	Situational irony.
19	**(a)** the second stanza	Cause moves to effect.
20	**(d)** irony of tone	Understatement.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 2 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	It stresses the ripe corn and Lencho's hope for rain (1) so that the loss feels larger by contrast (1).	1+1
22	He calls it a victory for justice and human dignity (1), so it is about right and wrong, not merely about power (1).	1+1
23	The seagull learns he is capable of flight (1) once he acts despite fear (1).	1+1
24	Naming creates a relationship (1) and turns a notebook into a confidante who 'listens' (1).	1+1
25	Bread is everyday yet central to festivals (1) so the baker links ordinary life with tradition (1).	1+1
26	The animal is removed from its natural home and exposed to stress (1), yet the author's care and affection partly offset the concern (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
27	Strength: it gives hope after ruin (1). Weakness: it makes him expect help without question (1). It causes him to misjudge the people who help (1).	1+1+1

28	He says to be free is to respect others' freedom (1). If some remain oppressed, the whole society stays unfree and unjust (1). Hence freedom is collective and interdependent (1).	1+1+1
29	The ledge above the sea provides danger (1). The wide sea signals freedom and fear (1). The setting makes the leap a physical and emotional climax (1).	1+1+1
30	It states why she writes (1). It states to whom she writes (1). It also reveals her character and need, making it a thesis for the whole diary (1).	1+1+1
31	He recalls the baker's routine fondly (1). Sensory details recreate childhood (1). Nostalgia reveals sadness at change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Affection motivates the journey and ensures good care (1). Yet the animal's welfare required better safeguards (1). The incident shows love needs prudence to be responsible (1).	1+1+1
32	Valli wants to be treated as an adult (1). 'Madam' fulfils her wish (1). The story shows it is natural and healthy (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is indirect and respects her feelings (1). It lets her reach the truth through experience (1). It may fail if the sufferer refuses to try (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

6 × 5 = 30

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
33	Lencho is the protagonist who suffers (1). The postmaster takes the decisions and acts (1). His kindness drives the plot (1). Lencho's faith inspires but the postmaster delivers (1). Conclusion: both essential, the postmaster is the moral hero (1).	2+2+1
34	Mandela is humble in sharing credit (1). He is courageous and defines true bravery (1). He offers forgiveness instead of revenge (1). He sets a vision of a just society (1). Overall, his words and life together show leadership guided by moral values (1).	2+2+1
35	Flight is the setting; fear is the theme (1). Most of the story is about hesitation (1). The leap is the climax (1). Flying is the proof that fear was unreal (1). The title suggests a beginning (1).	2+2+1
36	Opening defines diary as a friend (1). Kitty as listener (1). She records feelings, not facts (1). The Keesing story shows a lively mind (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Mosaic means separate pieces forming a pattern (1). Goa, Coorg, Assam (1). Different themes (1). No full coverage (1). Overall impression of unity in diversity (1).	2+2+1
37	Mij teaches Maxwell patience through chaos (1). He shows that play is a form of intelligence (1). He reveals the nature of otters (1). He tests assumptions about control over nature (1). Thus Mij educates his owner and the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Plot is simple (1). Message of growth (1). Use of symbols (1). Emotional impact (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
38	Denial in Kisa Gotami (1). The search as a method (1). Realisation of universality (1). Sermon's lines on grief (1). Peace and compassion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Characters reflect real traits (1). Quarrels show pettiness (1). Property and marriage satirised (1). Laughter invites reflection (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 20 × 1 = 20

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** rage normally implies noise	Contradiction.
2	**(c)** every stanza ends with a futile clue	Pattern.
3	**(d)** loss is a way of gaining knowledge	Knowledge through loss.
4	**(c)** it juxtaposes two simultaneous voices	Dual voice.
5	**(d)** extended personification	Trees as agents.
6	**(d)** presents a single precise image without commentary	Single image.
7	**(a)** treats a comic event in the style of a heroic tale	Comic epic style.
8	**(d)** the more beautiful Anne is, the harder it is to be loved for herself	Paradox of beauty.
9	**(d)** The ingratitude is the source of irony and shows human flaws	Defence of authorial choice.
10	**(b)** public ceremony to private reflection to universal message	Structural analysis.
11	**(d)** the black plane's sudden appearance and the radar's blank	The guide appears when he is lost but leaves no trace on radar.
12	**(c)** intimacy	A friendly address.
13	**(b)** organised, large-scale cultivation	Planned plantation.
14	**(c)** adapted to life in and near water	Adaptation.
15	**(c)** the moving bus	Movement and travel.
16	**(d)** told her directly	Direct statements would fail.
17	**(c)** comic effect	Exaggeration.
18	**(b)** tactful and kind	Ethical judgement.
19	**(c)** compassionate understanding	He is gentle with the thief.
20	**(d)** a tight single scene building to a twist	Compact plot.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 2 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	'Madam' honours Valli (1) while the idea of a child as 'Madam' is gently comic (1).	1+1
22	She seeks life for her son (1) but her search proves death is everywhere (1).	1+1
23	Delay creates comic tension (1) and lets the quarrels reveal character (1).	1+1
24	It is the vet's clinic (British usage) (1) and the operation the owner wrongly imagines (1).	1+1
25	It suggests a crime story told by the criminal (1) but the tale becomes a story of reform, which surprises us (1).	1+1
26	Max was an armed intruder threatening life (1) so deceiving him was self-defence rather than a moral fault (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
27	Two quarrels drive the plot (1). They reveal temperaments (1). The resolution comes only after exhaustion (1).	1+1+1
28	The title praises surgery (1). The cure was plain care (1). The ending reinforces the irony with Mrs Pumphrey's thanks (1).	1+1+1
29	The plain words and short sentences keep the tale close to Hari's voice. They avoid melodrama so that the moral emerges quietly. The simple style makes the profound idea of redemption more moving.	1+1+1
30	The title promises a night visitor and mystery. The first lines show Fowler's curiosity and Ausable's ordinary look. These set up the contrast and make Max's entrance a strong shock.	1+1+1

31	Horace deceives society by his respectable life. The woman deceives him with a false identity. The layers of deception create irony and give the plot a comic reversal.	1+1+1
	OR: Griffin's ambition drives him to a discovery but not to ask how it should be used. He uses it selfishly and suffers. The story criticises not science but the lack of conscience.	1+1+1
32	Richard's home supplied books and contacts, and his mother opened doors. Yet his own curiosity and effort did the work. The chapter shows environment and personal drive working together.	1+1+1
	OR: The details of money, rooms and jobs give a realistic picture of life. The sudden twist reveals an ironic design. The combination makes the moral memorable.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

6 × 5 = 30

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
33	Mrs Pumphrey's love (1). Harm to Tricki (1). Herriot's wisdom (1). The cure (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
34	Introduce redemption (1). Hari's initial intent to rob (1). Anil's trust and promise (1). Hari's conflict and return (1). Evaluation: believable and hopeful (1).	2+2+1
35	Thesis (1). Max's gun and force (1). Ausable's wit and trick (1). Role of fear and haste (1). Evaluation of the message (1).	2+2+1
36	Thesis (1). Horace's trust in a stranger (1). The woman's exploitation (1). Counter-view: some trust is necessary (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Define cautionary tale (1). Griffin's discovery (1). Misuse and consequences (1). Role of society (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
37	Thesis (1). Curiosity: collecting and questions (1). Support: mother and Dr Urquhart (1). Effort: experiments and prizes (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Define irony (1). Situational irony of the loss (1). Dramatic irony in the sacrifice (1). The final revelation (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
38	Define empowerment (1). Before school (1). Teacher and learning (1). The climax and decision (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Thesis (1). Martians' ignorance (1). Possible consequences (1). Luck rather than wisdom saves Earth (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTER

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–28) | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 80

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 20 × 1 = 20

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** he steals once a year and politely helps a stranger	Mild character.
2	**(a)** he is both gifted and morally flawed	Complex.
3	**(a)** taxonomy	Classification.
4	**(a)** foreshadowing	Hints at ruin.
5	**(a)** it creates suspense and a strong climax	Suspense.
6	**(b)** Had the Martians understood the book, they would have attacked.	Inversion.
7	**(c)** concentrated	Compact.
8	**(c)** extended metaphor	Fire and ice.
9	**(d)** an unresolved longing	Open-ended.
10	**(d)** gave a serious moral	Loses comedy.
11	**(d)** everything lost can be replaced	Replacement.
12	**(c)** only mental	Imaginary.
13	**(c)** leaves the poet's own fate unresolved	Ambiguity.
14	**(d)** The fog symbolises the quiet passing of time or moods	Symbolic.
15	**(c)** affectionate	Warm.
16	**(c)** Can anyone love without conditions?	Core.
17	**(d)** gullible	Gullible.
18	**(b)** inseparable	Cannot be divided.
19	**(a)** had not followed	Third conditional.
20	**(c)** The incorrigible boy never stopped teasing.	Describes a person who cannot be reformed.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 2 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	He portrays him as gentle, bookish and honest in manner (1) and makes him the victim of a deeper deceit, so we smile rather than condemn (1).	1+1
22	It stands for power without accountability (1) and for the isolation of a person cut off from human ties (1).	1+1
23	He uses familiar examples like butterflies and simple explanations (1) and links ideas to Richard's real experiences (1).	1+1
24	Mathilde suffers ten years (1) but the suffering is for a false cause and brings only worn looks, not obvious triumph, making it bitterly ironic (1).	1+1
25	Education and a kind teacher can build confidence (1) though the speed of change is compressed for the story's effect (1).	1+1
26	Satire lets the writer criticise pride and war through laughter (1) and the audience learns without feeling lectured (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 6 × 3 = 18

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
27	Realistic details of village life and prejudice give force. The transformation of Bholi and the ending are idealistic. The mix gives hope without ignoring injustice.	1+1+1
28	The audience knows the book is harmless, while the Martians believe it is menacing. This gap creates laughter and sympathy. We enjoy the Martians' errors and feel superior and relieved.	1+1+1
29	It names the physical cause (1). It hints at lightness and delicacy (1). It misleads us to expect nature description only (1).	1+1+1

30	The calm tone hides urgency (1). The comparison of emotions to catastrophe is a warning (1). It never preaches but makes us think (1).	1+1+1
31	The jungle imagery is vivid and active (1). The cage imagery is static (1). The contrast makes his loss tragic (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The voice is confident and cheerful (1). The content is deadly (1). The contrast generates satire (1).	1+1+1
32	It rejects false comfort (1). It values empathy and silence (1). It suggests that growth is internal (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It lets readers see inside and outside (1). It creates comic and sad contrast (1). It avoids narration (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

6 × 5 = 30

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
33	Theme (1). Structure (1). Imagery and symbolism (1). Tone and sound (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
34	Compact form (1). Symbolism (1). Moral implications (1). Tone (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
35	Silent rage (1). Controlled movement (1). Understated language (1). Longing (1). Overall effect (1).	2+2+1
36	Parody (1). Irony (1). Warning beneath (1). Tone (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The incident (1). Boy's grief (1). Poet's reflections (1). Universal meaning (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
37	Adult speaks (1). Child not heard (1). Inner voice (1). Imagination (1). Message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Trees as rebels (1). Quiet voice (1). Images of struggle (1). Poet's role (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
38	Six lines (1). One image (1). Suggestion (1). Reader's role (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Humour (1). Serious point on courage (1). Irony (1). Ending (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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